

2025-10-16 - Valentini (5)

Previous lecture: [2025-10-10 - Valentini \(4\)](#)

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Linearized VP equations

$$\begin{cases} \frac{\partial f_{\alpha 1}}{\partial t} + \bar{v} \cdot \nabla f_{\alpha 1} - \frac{\rho_{\alpha}}{m_{\alpha}} \nabla \phi_1 \cdot \nabla_{\bar{v}} f_{\alpha 0} = 0 \\ -\nabla^2 \phi_1 = 4\pi \sum_{\alpha} \rho_{\alpha} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f_{\alpha 1}(\bar{r}, \bar{v}, t) d^3 v \end{cases}$$

VM distribution

$$f_{\alpha 0} = \frac{n_{\alpha 0} m_{\alpha}^{3/2}}{(2\pi k_B T_{\alpha 0})^{3/2}} \exp \left[-\frac{m_{\alpha} v^2}{2k_B T_{\alpha 0}} \right]$$
$$\phi_0 = 0, \quad n_{i0} = n_{e0} = n_0$$

Laplace transform

$$\mathcal{L}[f(t)](p) = \tilde{f}(p) = \int_0^{\infty} f(t) e^{-pt} dt$$

complex number p_1

$$\exists p_1 \in \mathbb{C} \text{ s.t. } \int_0^{\infty} |f(t) e^{-pt}| dt < \infty$$

is convergent.

If there exists two constants M and $p_0 \in \mathbb{R}$ such that

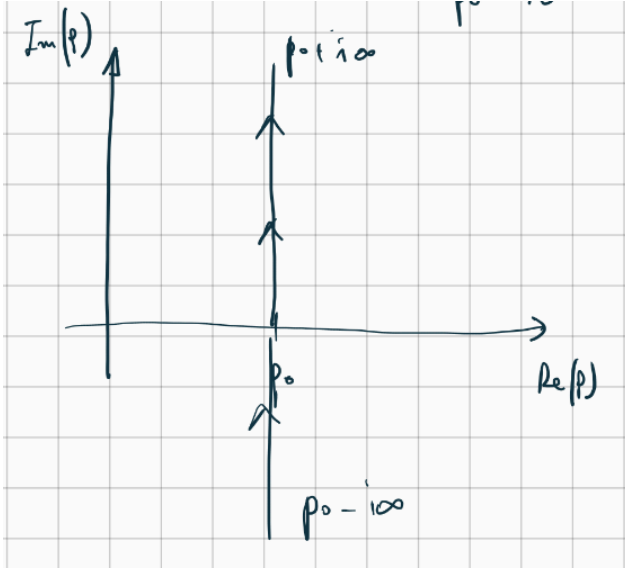
$$|f(t)| \leq M e^{p_0 t} \implies \tilde{f}(p) \text{ is well defined } \forall \operatorname{Re}(p) \geq p_0$$

with p_0 "indice di crescita" or growth index

The inverse transform is

$$\mathcal{L}[\tilde{f}(p)]^{-1}(t) = f(t) = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{p_0 - i\infty}^{p_0 + i\infty} e^{pt} \tilde{f}(p) dp$$

pic 01 - invs lap integral



We want to transform $f_{\alpha 1}$ and ϕ_1

$$\text{Fourier transform} \begin{cases} f_{\alpha \bar{k}}(\bar{v}, t) = \frac{1}{(2\pi)^3} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-i\bar{k} \cdot \bar{r}} f_{\alpha 1}(\bar{r}, \bar{v}, t) d^3 r \\ \phi_{\bar{k}}(t) = \frac{1}{(2\pi)^3} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-i\bar{k} \cdot \bar{r}} \phi_1(t) d^3 r \end{cases}$$

$$\text{Laplace transform} \begin{cases} \tilde{f}_{\alpha k}(\bar{v}, p) = \int_0^{\infty} e^{-pt} f_{\alpha \bar{k}}(\bar{v}, t) dt \\ \tilde{\phi}_k(p) = \int_0^{\infty} e^{-pt} \phi_{\bar{k}}(t) dt \end{cases}$$

for $\text{Re}(p) \geq p_0$

and

$$f_{\alpha 1}(\bar{r}, \bar{v}, t) = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{p_0 - i\infty}^{p_0 + i\infty} dp e^{pt} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{i\bar{k} \cdot \bar{r}} \tilde{f}_{\alpha \bar{k}}(\bar{v}, p) d^3 k$$

$$\phi_1(\bar{r}, t) = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{p_0 - i\infty}^{p_0 + i\infty} dp e^{pt} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{i\bar{k} \cdot \bar{r}} \tilde{\phi}_{\bar{k}}(p) d^3 k$$

Vlasov equation in Laplace transform

We transform Vlasov equation in space using Fourier transform and in time using Laplace transform

$$\int_0^{\infty} e^{-pt} dt \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{-i\bar{k} \cdot \bar{r}}}{(2\pi)^3} d^3 r \left[\frac{\partial f_{\alpha 1}}{\partial t} + \bar{v} \cdot \nabla f_{\alpha 1} - \frac{\rho_{\alpha}}{m_a} \nabla \phi_1 \cdot \nabla_{\bar{v}} f_{\alpha 0} \right] = 0$$

$$\int_0^{\infty} e^{-pt} dt \left[\frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{-i\bar{k} \cdot \bar{r}}}{(2\pi)^3} f_{\alpha 1} d^3 r + \bar{v} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{-i\bar{k} \cdot \bar{r}}}{(2\pi)^3} \nabla f_{\alpha 1} d^3 r - \frac{\rho_{\alpha}}{m_a} \nabla_{\bar{v}} f_{\alpha 0} \cdot \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{-i\bar{k} \cdot \bar{r}}}{(2\pi)^3} \nabla \phi_1 d^3 r \right] = 0$$

The **first integral** becomes

$$I_1 = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{-i\bar{k} \cdot \bar{r}}}{(2\pi)^3} f_{\alpha 1} d^3 r = f_{\alpha \bar{k}}(\bar{v}, t)$$

The **second integral** becomes

$$I_2 = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{-i\vec{k}\cdot\vec{r}}}{(2\pi)^3} \nabla f_{\alpha 1} d^3r = \frac{1}{(2\pi)^3} \left(\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-i\vec{k}\cdot\vec{r}} \frac{\partial f_{\alpha 1}}{\partial x} d^3r, \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-i\vec{k}\cdot\vec{r}} \frac{\partial f_{\alpha 1}}{\partial y} d^3r, \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-i\vec{k}\cdot\vec{r}} \frac{\partial f_{\alpha 1}}{\partial z} d^3r \right)$$

and the integral in the x direction is (solving by parts)

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-i\vec{k}\cdot\vec{r}} \frac{\partial f_{\alpha 1}}{\partial x} d^3r &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dz e^{-ik_z z} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dy e^{-ik_y y} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dx e^{-ik_x x} \left(\frac{\partial f_{\alpha 1}}{\partial x} \right) \\ &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dz e^{-ik_z z} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dy e^{-ik_y y} \left[\cancel{f_{\alpha 1} e^{-ik_x x}} \Big|_{-\infty}^{+\infty} - \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f_{\alpha 1} (-ik_x) e^{-ik_x x} dx \right] \\ &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dz e^{-ik_z z} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dy e^{-ik_y y} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} (ik_x) f_{\alpha 1} e^{-ik_x x} dx \\ &= (ik_x) \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dz e^{-ik_z z} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dy e^{-ik_y y} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f_{\alpha 1} e^{-ik_x x} dx \\ &= (ik_x) \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f_{\alpha 1} e^{-i\vec{k}\cdot\vec{r}} d^3r \end{aligned}$$

we can cancel that term because $f_{\alpha 1}$ goes to zero at infinity
for y and z we have

$$\begin{aligned} y : \quad & ik_y \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f_{\alpha 1} e^{-i\vec{k}\cdot\vec{r}} d^3r \\ z : \quad & ik_z \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f_{\alpha 1} e^{-i\vec{k}\cdot\vec{r}} d^3r \end{aligned}$$

so

$$I_2 = i\vec{k} f_{\alpha\vec{k}}(\vec{v}, t)$$

The **third integral** becomes (using the same reasoning as before)

$$I_3 = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{-i\vec{k}\cdot\vec{r}}}{(2\pi)^3} \nabla \phi_1 d^3r = i\vec{k} \phi_{\vec{k}}(t)$$

So we have

$$\int_0^{\infty} e^{-pt} dt \left[\frac{\partial}{\partial t} f_{\alpha\vec{k}}(\vec{v}, t) + i\vec{v} \cdot \vec{k} f_{\alpha\vec{k}}(\vec{v}, t) - \frac{\rho_{\alpha}}{m_a} \nabla_{\vec{v}} f_{\alpha 0} \cdot i\vec{k} \phi_{\vec{k}}(t) \right] = 0$$

Now we solve the time integral

The **first integral** becomes

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^{\infty} e^{-pt} \frac{\partial}{\partial t} f_{\alpha\vec{k}}(\vec{v}, t) dt &= e^{-pt} f_{\alpha\vec{k}}(\vec{v}, t) \Big|_0^{\infty} - \int_0^{\infty} [-p e^{-pt} f_{\alpha\vec{k}}(\vec{v}, t)] dt \\ &= -f_{\alpha\vec{k}}(\vec{v}, t=0) + p \tilde{f}_{\alpha\vec{k}}(\vec{v}, p) \end{aligned}$$

The **second integral** becomes

$$\int_0^{\infty} e^{-pt} (i\vec{v} \cdot \vec{k}) f_{\alpha\vec{k}}(\vec{v}, t) dt = i\vec{v} \cdot \vec{k} \tilde{f}_{\alpha\vec{k}}(\vec{v}, p)$$

The **third integral** becomes

$$\int_0^\infty e^{-pt} \left(\frac{\rho_\alpha}{m_a} \nabla_{\bar{v}} f_{\alpha 0} \cdot i\bar{k} \right) \phi_{\bar{k}}(t) dt = \frac{\rho_\alpha}{m_a} \nabla_{\bar{v}} f_{\alpha 0} \cdot i\bar{k} \tilde{\phi}_{\bar{k}}(p)$$

And the full equation becomes

$$-f_{\alpha\bar{k}}(\bar{v}, t=0) + p\tilde{f}_{\alpha\bar{k}}(\bar{v}, p) + i\bar{v} \cdot \bar{k} \tilde{f}_{\alpha\bar{k}}(\bar{v}, p) - i\frac{\rho_\alpha}{m_a} \nabla_{\bar{v}} f_{\alpha 0} \cdot \bar{k} \tilde{\phi}_{\bar{k}}(p) = 0$$

Poisson equation in Laplace transform

$$-\nabla^2 \phi_1 = 4\pi \sum_{\alpha} \rho_{\alpha} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f_{\alpha 1}(\bar{r}, \bar{v}, t) d^3v$$

We apply the transformations as before

$$\int_0^\infty e^{-pt} dt \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{-i\bar{k} \cdot \bar{r}}}{(2\pi)^3} \left[\nabla^2 \phi_1 + 4\pi \sum_{\alpha} \rho_{\alpha} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f_{\alpha 1} d^3v \right] d^3r = 0$$

The **second term** becomes

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^\infty e^{-pt} dt \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{-i\bar{k} \cdot \bar{r}}}{(2\pi)^3} \left[4\pi \sum_{\alpha} \rho_{\alpha} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f_{\alpha 1} d^3v \right] d^3r &= \\ &= 4\pi \sum_{\alpha} \rho_{\alpha} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left[\int_0^\infty e^{-pt} dt \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{-i\bar{k} \cdot \bar{r}}}{(2\pi)^3} f_{\alpha 1} d^3r \right] d^3v = \\ &= 4\pi \sum_{\alpha} \rho_{\alpha} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \tilde{f}_{\alpha\bar{k}} d^3v \end{aligned}$$

Now we consider the Fourier transformation of the **first term**, which becomes

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-i\bar{k} \cdot \bar{r}} \nabla^2 \phi_1 d^3r &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-i\bar{k} \cdot \bar{r}} \left(\frac{\partial^2 \phi_1}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 \phi_1}{\partial y^2} + \frac{\partial^2 \phi_1}{\partial z^2} \right) d^3r = \\ &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dz e^{-ik_z z} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dy e^{-ik_y y} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dx e^{-ik_x x} \left(\frac{\partial^2 \phi_1}{\partial x^2} \right) + \\ &+ \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dz e^{-ik_z z} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dx e^{-ik_x x} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dy e^{-ik_y y} \left(\frac{\partial^2 \phi_1}{\partial y^2} \right) + \\ &+ \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dx e^{-ik_x x} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dy e^{-ik_y y} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dz e^{-ik_z z} \left(\frac{\partial^2 \phi_1}{\partial z^2} \right) \end{aligned}$$

Now, we solve the integral by parts two times and we use the fact that the electric potential (and also its derivative) goes to zero at infinity. We have

$$\begin{aligned}
\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-ik_x x} \frac{\partial^2 \phi_1}{\partial x^2} dx &= \cancel{\frac{\partial \phi_1}{\partial x} e^{-ik_x x} \Big|_{-\infty}^{+\infty}} - \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} (-ik_x) \frac{\partial \phi_1}{\partial x} e^{-ik_x x} dx = \\
&= ik_x \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} \frac{\partial \phi_1}{\partial x} e^{-ik_x x} dx = \\
&= \cancel{ik_x \phi_1 e^{-ik_x x} \Big|_{-\infty}^{+\infty}} - ik_x \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} (-ik_x) \phi_1 e^{-ik_x x} dx = \\
&= -k_x^2 \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} \phi_1 e^{-ik_x x} dx
\end{aligned}$$

And the same reasoning works for the other two integrals in y and z

So we have

$$\begin{aligned}
\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{-i\vec{k} \cdot \vec{r}}}{(2\pi)^3} \nabla^2 \phi_1 d^3 r &= -k_x^2 \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{-i\vec{k} \cdot \vec{r}}}{(2\pi)^3} \phi_1 d^3 r - k_y^2 \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{-i\vec{k} \cdot \vec{r}}}{(2\pi)^3} \phi_1 d^3 r - k_z^2 \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{-i\vec{k} \cdot \vec{r}}}{(2\pi)^3} \phi_1 d^3 r = \\
&= -(k_x^2 + k_y^2 + k_z^2) \cdot \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e^{-i\vec{k} \cdot \vec{r}}}{(2\pi)^3} \phi_1 d^3 r = \\
&= -k^2 \phi_{\vec{k}}(t)
\end{aligned}$$

Now we substitute these results and we get

$$\int_0^{\infty} e^{-pt} dt (-k^2 \phi_{\vec{k}}(t)) + 4\pi \sum_{\alpha} \rho_{\alpha} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \tilde{f}_{\alpha \vec{k}} d^3 v = 0$$

The first term actually is

$$-k^2 \tilde{\phi}_{\vec{k}}(p) + 4\pi \sum_{\alpha} \rho_{\alpha} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \tilde{f}_{\alpha \vec{k}} d^3 v = 0$$

and finally we have obtained the

Vlasov-Poisson equations in Laplace-Fourier space

$$\begin{cases} -f_{\alpha \vec{k}}(\vec{v}, t=0) + p \tilde{f}_{\alpha \vec{k}}(\vec{v}, p) + i\vec{v} \cdot \vec{k} \tilde{f}_{\alpha \vec{k}}(\vec{v}, p) - i \frac{\rho_{\alpha}}{m_a} \vec{k} \cdot \nabla_{\vec{v}} f_{\alpha 0} \tilde{\phi}_{\vec{k}}(p) = 0 \\ -k^2 \tilde{\phi}_{\vec{k}}(p) + 4\pi \sum_{\alpha} \rho_{\alpha} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \tilde{f}_{\alpha \vec{k}} d^3 v = 0 \end{cases}$$

In particular, we can isolate the electric potential.

First we isolate the distribution function

$$\begin{aligned}
\tilde{f}_{\alpha \vec{k}}(\vec{v}, p) \left[p + i\vec{v} \cdot \vec{k} \right] &= f_{\alpha \vec{k}}(\vec{v}, t=0) + i \frac{\rho_{\alpha}}{m_a} \vec{k} \cdot \nabla_{\vec{v}} f_{\alpha 0} \tilde{\phi}_{\vec{k}}(p) \\
\Rightarrow \tilde{f}_{\alpha \vec{k}}(\vec{v}, p) &= \frac{f_{\alpha \vec{k}}(\vec{v}, t=0) + i \frac{\rho_{\alpha}}{m_a} \vec{k} \cdot \nabla_{\vec{v}} f_{\alpha 0} \tilde{\phi}_{\vec{k}}(p)}{p + i\vec{v} \cdot \vec{k}}
\end{aligned}$$

Then we substitute it in the Poisson equation

$$\begin{aligned}
k^2 \tilde{\phi}_{\bar{k}}(p) &= 4\pi \sum_{\alpha} \rho_{\alpha} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \left[\frac{f_{\alpha\bar{k}}(\bar{v}, t=0) + i \frac{\rho_{\alpha}}{m_a} \bar{k} \cdot \nabla_{\bar{v}} f_{\alpha 0} \tilde{\phi}_{\bar{k}}(p)}{p + i\bar{v} \cdot \bar{k}} \right] d^3v \\
\Rightarrow k^2 \tilde{\phi}_{\bar{k}}(p) &= 4\pi \sum_{\alpha} \rho_{\alpha} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{f_{\alpha\bar{k}}(\bar{v}, t=0)}{p + i\bar{v} \cdot \bar{k}} d^3v + 4\pi i \sum_{\alpha} \frac{\rho_{\alpha}^2}{m_a} \bar{k} \tilde{\phi}_{\bar{k}}(p) \cdot \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{\nabla_{\bar{v}} f_{\alpha 0}}{p + i\bar{v} \cdot \bar{k}} d^3v \\
\Rightarrow k^2 \tilde{\phi}_{\bar{k}}(p) \left[1 - \frac{4\pi}{k^2} i \sum_{\alpha} \frac{\rho_{\alpha}^2}{m_a} \bar{k} \cdot \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{\nabla_{\bar{v}} f_{\alpha 0}}{p + i\bar{v} \cdot \bar{k}} d^3v \right] &= 4\pi \sum_{\alpha} \rho_{\alpha} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{f_{\alpha\bar{k}}(\bar{v}, t=0)}{p + i\bar{v} \cdot \bar{k}} d^3v \\
\Rightarrow k^2 \tilde{\phi}_{\bar{k}}(p) &= \frac{4\pi \sum_{\alpha} \rho_{\alpha} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{f_{\alpha\bar{k}}(\bar{v}, t=0)}{p + i\bar{v} \cdot \bar{k}} d^3v}{1 - \frac{4\pi}{k^2} i \sum_{\alpha} \frac{\rho_{\alpha}^2}{m_a} \bar{k} \cdot \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{\nabla_{\bar{v}} f_{\alpha 0}}{p + i\bar{v} \cdot \bar{k}} d^3v}
\end{aligned}$$

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